Chapter One

The voice and the page

Most audiobooks ask you to close your eyes. This one asks you to keep them open.

What you are looking at is a page. A real page, with its own margins and its own type. The voice you are hearing is reading that page, and as it reads, the sentence being spoken is lit; inside the sentence, a single word moves along with the voice.

That is the whole idea, and everything else here is in service of it. A recording and a book are usually two separate things — one on a shelf, one in your ears, with no way to get from one to the other. Here they are the same object. When the voice says a word, you can see where it is. When you see a word, you can hear it.

It sounds like a small thing. It is not. Reading with your eyes and your ears at once is how most people read faster than with either alone, and it is how a language you are learning stops being a wall. It is also, simply, a pleasant way to be read to without ever losing your place.

You are reading this inside the app right now. Look at the word being spoken. That is the product.

Chapter Two

Reading with your thumb

The page you are on is the whole page, not a slice of one. Scroll through it, through the chapter, and out the other side into the next.

Tap twice on any sentence and the voice goes there. It is the fastest way through a book there has ever been: you do not drag a bar and guess — you point at the words you want.

Tap once and the chrome goes. The bars, the buttons, the numbers all leave, and you have the page and nothing else. Tap again and they come back.

If the print is too small, or you would rather the words reflowed at a size you chose, there is a text view, and the narration follows you into it. If a chapter was never narrated, it still opens. It simply does not speak.

At the foot of every chapter is a row naming the next one. There is nothing to hunt for; you reach it by finishing.

And a book that is only words, or only a voice, opens here too. The app asks each book what it can do and shows you that, and never mentions what it cannot.